

**Severe Hepatic Impairment:**  
There are no data for patients with severe hepatic impairment.

**Aspartame:**  
Donepezil hydrochloride orodispersible tablets contain aspartame, a source of phenylalanine. This product is unsuitable for phenylketonurics.

**Interactions with other medicinal products and other forms of interaction**  
Donepezil hydrochloride and/or any of its metabolites do not inhibit the metabolism of theophylline, warfarin, cimetidine or digoxin in humans. The metabolism of donepezil hydrochloride is not affected by concurrent administration of digoxin or cimetidine. Cytochrome P450 isoenzymes 3A4 and to a minor extent 2D6 are involved in the metabolism of donepezil. Drug interaction studies performed show that ketoconazole and quinidine, inhibitors of CYP3A4 and 2D6 respectively, inhibit donepezil metabolism. Therefore, these and other CYP3A4 inhibitors, such as itraconazole and erythromycin, and CYP2D6 inhibitors, such as fluoxetine, could inhibit the metabolism of donepezil. Ketoconazole increased mean donepezil concentrations by about 30%. Enzyme inducers, such as rifampicin, phenytoin, carbamazepine and alcohol may reduce the levels of donepezil. Since the magnitude of an inhibiting or inducing effect is unknown, such drug combinations should be used with care. Donepezil hydrochloride has the potential to interfere with medications having anticholinergic activity. There is also the potential for synergistic activity with concomitant treatment involving medications such as succinylcholine, other neuro-muscular blocking agents or cholinergic agonists or beta blocking agents that have effects on cardiac conduction.

Cases of QT interval prolongation and Torsade de Pointes have been reported for donepezil. Caution is advised when donepezil is used in combination with other medicinal products known to prolong the QT interval and clinical monitoring (ECG) may be required. Examples include:

- Class IA antiarrhythmics (e.g. guinidine)
- Class III antiarrhythmics (e.g. amiodarone, sotalol)
- Certain antidepressants (e.g. citalopram, escitalopram, amitriptyline)
- Other antipsychotics (e.g. phenothiazine derivatives, sertindole, pimozide, ziprasidone)
- Certain antibiotics (e.g. clarithromycin, erythromycin, levofloxacin, moxifloxacin)

**Pregnancy and lactation**  
**Pregnancy:**  
There are no adequate data from the use of donepezil in pregnant women. Studies in animals have not shown teratogenic effect but have shown peri and post natal toxicity. The potential risk for humans is unknown. Donepezil should not be used during pregnancy unless clearly necessary.

**Breastfeeding:**  
Donepezil is excreted in the milk of rats. It is not known whether donepezil hydrochloride is excreted in human breast milk and there are no studies in lactating women. Therefore, women on donepezil should not breast feed.

**Effects on ability to drive and use machines**  
Donepezil has minor or moderate influence on the ability to drive and use machines. Dementia may cause impairment of driving performance or compromise the ability to use machinery. Furthermore, donepezil can induce fatigue, dizziness and muscle cramps, mainly when initiating or increasing the dose. The treating physician should routinely evaluate the ability of patients on donepezil to continue driving or operating complex machines.

**Undesirable effects**  
The most common adverse events are diarrhoea, muscle cramps, fatigue, nausea, vomiting, headache and insomnia.

| System organ class                                   | Very Common         | Common                                                                                        | Uncommon                                                        | Rare                                        | Very Rare                      | Not known                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Infections and infestations                          |                     | Common cold                                                                                   |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Metabolism and nutrition disorders                   |                     | Anorexia                                                                                      |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Psychiatric disorders                                |                     | Hallucinations**<br>Agitation**<br>Aggressive behaviour**<br>Abnormal dreams and Nightmares** |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Nervous system disorders                             |                     | Syncope*<br>Dizziness<br>Insomnia                                                             | Seizure*                                                        | Extrapyramidal symptoms                     | Neuroleptic malignant syndrome |                                                                                                             |
| Cardiac disorders                                    |                     |                                                                                               | Bradycardia                                                     | Sino-atrial block<br>Atrioventricular block |                                | Polymorphic ventricular tachycardia including Torsade de Pointes<br>Electrocardiogram QT interval prolonged |
| Gastrointestinal disorders                           | Diarrhoea<br>Nausea | Vomiting<br>Abdominal disturbance                                                             | Gastrointestinal haemorrhage<br>Gastric and duodenal ulcers     |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Hepato-biliary disorders                             |                     |                                                                                               |                                                                 | Liver dysfunction including hepatitis***    |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders               |                     | Rash<br>Pruritis                                                                              |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Musculoskeletal connective tissue and bone disorders |                     | Muscle cramps                                                                                 |                                                                 |                                             | Rhabdomyolysis****             |                                                                                                             |
| Renal and urinary disorders                          |                     | Urinary incontinence                                                                          |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| General disorders and administration site disorders  | Headache            | Fatigue<br>Pain                                                                               |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Investigations                                       |                     |                                                                                               | Minor increase in serum concentration of muscle creatine kinase |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |
| Injury and poisoning                                 |                     | Accident                                                                                      |                                                                 |                                             |                                |                                                                                                             |

\*In investigating patients for syncope or seizure the possibility of heart block or long sinusual pauses should be considered.

\*\*Reports of hallucinations, abnormal dreams, nightmares, agitation and aggressive behaviour have resolved on dose-reduction or discontinuation of treatment.

\*\*\*In cases of unexplained liver dysfunction, withdrawal of donepezil should be considered.

\*\*\*\*Rhabdomyolysis has been reported to occur independently of neuroleptic malignant syndrome and in close temporal association with donepezil initiation or dose increase

**Overdose**  
**Symptoms:**  
Overdosage with cholinesterase inhibitors can result in cholinergic crisis characterized by severe nausea, vomiting, salivation, sweating, bradycardia, hypotension, respiratory depression, collapse and convulsions. Increasing muscle weakness is a possibility and may result in death if respiratory muscles are involved.

**Treatment:**  
As in any case of overdose, general supportive measures should be utilised. Tertiary anticholinergics such as atropine may be used as an antidote for donepezil overdosage. Intravenous atropine sulphate titrated to effect is recommended: an initial dose of 1.0 to 2.0 mg intravenous with subsequent doses based upon clinical response. Atypical responses in blood pressure and heart rate have been reported with other cholinomimetics when co-administered with quaternary anticholinergics such as glycopyrrolate. It is not known whether donepezil hydrochloride and/or its metabolites can be removed by dialysis (haemodialysis, peritoneal dialysis, or haemofiltration).

**List of excipients**  
Polacrillin potassium  
Hydrochloric acid, concentrated  
Water, purified  
Cellulose, microcrystalline  
Lactose monohydrate (spray dried)  
Monosodium citrate anhydrous  
Aspartame  
Croscarmellose sodium  
Silica, colloidal anhydrous  
Magnesium stearate

**Storage condition**  
Store at temperature below 30°C, out of the sight and reach of children.

**Dosage forms and packaging available**  
**DONEPEZIL/GENEPHARM 5 mg orodispersible tablet**  
2 x 14 tablets in PVC/ PCTFE/Aluminium blister  
2 x 14 tablets Aluminium/Aluminium blister

**DONEPEZIL/GENEPHARM 10 mg orodispersible tablet**  
2 x 14 tablets in PVC/ PCTFE/Aluminium blister  
2 x 14 tablets Aluminium/Aluminium blister

**Name and Address of manufacturer**  
GENEPHARM S.A.  
18th KMMARATHONOS AVENUE, PALLINI, 15351, GREECE

**Date Of Revision**  
14/12/2023